



(12) **United States Plant Patent**  
**Fleming**

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(54) **ILlicium PLANT NAMED ‘JCJC’**  
(50) Latin Name: *Illicium floridanum*  
Varietal Denomination: **JCJC**  
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(73) Assignee: **Plant Development Services Inc.**,  
Loxley, AL (US)  
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patent is extended or adjusted under 35  
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See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**  
A new and distinct *Illicium* cultivar named ‘JCJC’ is dis-  
closed, characterized by rounded foliage, dark red flowers  
with a sweet fragrance. Plant form of the new cultivar is  
attractive, requiring little or no pruning. The new cultivar is a  
*Illicium*, suitable for ornamental garden purposes.

**2 Drawing Sheets**

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Latin name of the genus and species: *Illicium floridanum*.  
Variety denomination: ‘JCJC’.

**BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION**

The new cultivar is a product of a chance discovery in a  
commercial setting by the inventor. In approximately 1992  
and 1994, the inventor, James Fleming collected seed of the  
native species, *Illicium floridanum*. The collected seed was  
planted at a commercial nursery in Newberry, Fla., and seed-  
lings observed for interesting horticultural variations.

During the late 1990s the inventor noticed a seedling with  
an attractive plant shape and different leaf form. The seedling  
was then selected and propagated by semi-hardwood cuttings  
at the commercial nursery in Newberry, Fla. The initial propa-  
gation showed the plant to be stable and additional genera-  
tions were propagated, also by semi-hardwood cuttings. Mul-  
tiple generations have been reproduced since approximately  
2000, and have shown that the unique features of this cultivar  
are stable and reproduced true to type.

**SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION**

The cultivar ‘JCJC’ has not been observed under all pos-  
sible environmental conditions. The phenotype may vary  
somewhat with variations in environment such as tempera-  
ture, day length, and light intensity, without, however, any  
variance in genotype. The following traits have been repeat-  
edly observed and are determined to be the unique character-  
istics of ‘JCJC’ These characteristics in combination distin-  
guish ‘JCJC’ as a new and distinct *Illicium* cultivar:

1. Unusual sweet fragrance
2. Dark red flowers
3. Attractive dense plant form, requiring little or no pruning
4. Rounded foliage.

**COMPARISON TO PARENT VARIETY**

Plants of the new cultivar ‘JCJC’ are similar to plants of the  
parent; *Illicium floridanum* in most horticultural characteris-

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tics, however, plants of the new cultivar ‘JCJC’ have foliage  
with a rounded shape. Additionally, plants of ‘JCJC’ produce  
darker red flowers with a sweet scent not found in the parent  
variety. Plant shape is improved in the new variety, forming  
attractive, dense plants that are less rangy than the parent.

**COMMERCIAL COMPARISON**

‘JCJC’ is best compared to the commercial variety *Illicium*  
*floridanum* ‘Pink Frost’ U.S. Plant Pat. No. 21,287. Plants of  
the new cultivar ‘JCJC’ are similar to plants of ‘Pink Frost’ in  
most horticultural characteristics, however, plants of the new  
cultivar ‘JCJC’ produce flowers with a unique sweet fra-  
grance, compared to the malodorous fragrance of this ‘Pink  
Frost’. Flower color of ‘JCJC’ is significantly darker than  
‘PinkFrost’.

‘JCJC’ can also be compared to the commercial variety  
*Illicium floridanum* ‘Variegated *Illicium*’ U.S. Plant Pat. No.  
16,269. Plants of the new cultivar ‘JCJC’ are similar to plants  
of this comparator in most horticultural characteristics, how-  
ever, plants of the new cultivar ‘JCJC’ have solid green foli-  
age. Additionally, plants of ‘JCJC’ produce flowers with a  
unique sweet fragrance, compared to the fishy fragrance of  
this comparator. Flower color of ‘JCJC’ is significantly darker  
than this comparator.

**BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS**

The accompanying photograph in FIG. 1 illustrates in full  
color a close up of typical foliage and flowers of ‘JCJC’ grown  
outdoors in Loxley, Ala.

FIG. 2 illustrates in full color a typical plant of ‘JCJC’  
grown outdoors in Alabama. The plant is approximately 5  
years old, and is planted in the ground.

The photographs were taken using conventional tech-  
niques and although colors may appear different from actual  
colors due to light reflectance it is as accurate as possible by  
conventional photographic techniques.

**DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION**

In the following description, color references are made to  
The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart 2001 except

where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. The following observations and measurements describe 'JCJC' plants grown outdoors in Loxley, Ala. Plants are approximately 3 years old, in a 3 gallon nursery container. Measurements and numerical values represent averages of 5 typical plant types.

Botanical classification: *Illicium floridanum* 'JCJC'.

#### PROPAGATION

Time to rooting: Approximately 6 weeks at approximately 32° C. from semi-hardwood cuttings.

Root description: Fine, fibrous young roots. Older roots becoming woody, colored near Grey-Brown 199C.

#### PLANT

Growth habit: Upright shrub. Moderately dense. Slow to moderate growth rate.

Height: Approximately 45 cm.

Plant spread: Approximately 60 cm. 10 year old mature plant is approximately 200 cm high by 150 cm wide.

Branching characteristics: Moderate branching, angled approximately 45° to 75°.

Length of lateral branches: Approximately 15 to 25 cm.

Number of lateral branches: Approximately 5 main lateral branches on a 3 year old plant.

Diameter of lateral branches: Approximately 1.2 cm.

Lateral branch strength: Very strong, with somewhat brittle.

Lateral branch color: Young branches near RHS Greyed-Green 197B. Mature branches near RHS Greyed-Green 195A.

Branch texture: Coarse. Irregular lenticels, colored Greyed-Orange 165B.

Number of leaves per lateral branch: Average 10 to 15.

Age of plant described: Approximately 3 years.

#### FOLIAGE

Leaf:

*Type*.—Simple.

*Arrangement*.—Pseudo-whorled, 5 to 7 per terminal whorl.

*Average length*.—Approximately 9 cm.

*Average width*.—Approximately 4.5 cm.

*Shape of blade*.—Obovate.

*Apex*.—Obtuse, to occasionally semi-mucronate, with a small spicule attached to the underside of leaf, rather than at actual apex.

*Base*.—Cuneate.

*Attachment*.—Stalked.

*Margin*.—Entire.

*Texture of top surface*.—Smooth, leathery.

*Texture of bottom surface*.—Smooth, leathery.

*Foliage scent*.—Anise-like.

*Color*.—Young foliage upper side: near RHS Green 137A. Young foliage under side: near RHS Green 137B. Mature foliage upper side: near RHS Green 139A, but darker. Mature foliage under side: near RHS Green 138A.

*Venation*.—Type: Pinnate. Venation color upper side: Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B. Venation color under side: Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B.

*Petiole*.—Length: Near 1.5 cm. Diameter: Near 0.4 cm. Color: Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B.

*Stipule*.—Irregularly present. Length: Near 1.5 cm. Diameter: Near 0.4 cm. Margin: Ciliate. Shape: Deltoid. Color: Upper Surface: Near RHS Greyed-Orange 164A and 164B, both colors present. Under Surface: Near RHS Greyed-Orange 164C.

#### FLOWER

Bloom period:

*Natural season*.—December to March in Georgia.

Flower:

*Arrangement*.—Single star shaped flowers, occurring at leaf axils.

*Diameter*.—Approximately 3.5 cm.

*Depth*.—Approximately 3.0 cm.

*Facing direction*.—Outwardly facing, at approximately 45° angle from stem attachment.

*Persistent or self-cleaning*.—Persistent.

*Fragrance*.—Sweet, pleasant.

Petals:

*Length*.—Approximately 1.6 cm.

*Width*.—Approximately 0.5 cm.

*Apex*.—Blunt.

*Shape of petal*.—Ovate.

*Petal margin*.—Entire.

*Petal arrangement*.—Radial, slightly overlapping.

*Petal number*.—Average 25.

*Petal texture*.—Smooth.

*Color*.—Upper surface at first opening: Near RHS Red 53A. Under surface at first opening: Near RHS Red 53B. Upper surface at maturity: Near RHS Red-Purple 60A. Under surface at maturity: Near RHS Red-Purple 60A. Upper surface at fading: Near RHS Red-Purple 59A. Under surface at fading: Near RHS Red-Purple 59A.

Bud:

*Shape*.—Oblong.

*Length*.—1 to 1.5 cm.

*Diameter*.—0.9 cm.

*Color*.—Near RHS Red-Purple 59B.

Calyx/sepals:

*Quantity per flower*.—5 sepals.

*Shape*.—Spatulate.

*Length*.—Average 1.0 cm.

*Width*.—0.4 cm.

*Apex*.—Obtuse.

*Base*.—Attenuate.

*Margin*.—Entire.

*Texture*.—Smooth.

*Color*.—Upper Surface: Near RHS Yellow-Green 145B and 145C, both colors present with a faint, irregular flush mainly along margins of Red-Purple 59C. Lower Surface: Near RHS Yellow-Green 145B and 145C, both colors present with a faint, irregular flush mainly along margins of Red-Purple 59C.

Peduncle:

*Length*.—Average 1.1 cm.

*Diameter*.—0.25 cm.

*Color*.—Near RHS Yellow-Green 145B.

*Texture*.—Glabrous.

Bracteoles:

*Quantity per flower*.—Most commonly 2.

*Shape*.—Deltoid.

*Length*.—Average 1.1 cm.

*Width*.—0.8 cm.

*Aspect.*—Strongly concave.  
*Apex.*—Acute.  
*Base.*—Cuneate.  
*Margin.*—Entire.  
*Texture.*—Smooth.  
*Color.*—Upper Surface: Near RHS Yellow-Green 145B with a flush of Greyed-Purple 185C. Lower Surface: Near RHS Yellow-Green 145B with a flush along margins of Greyed-Purple 185C.

REPRODUCTIVE ORGANS

Stamens:  
*Number.*—35.  
*Length.*—0.2 cm.  
*Width.*—0.1 cm.  
*Color.*—Near RHS Greyed-Purple 187A.

Pistil:  
*Number.*—1.  
*Length.*—0.4 cm.  
*Style.*—Length: 0.2 cm. Color: Near RHS Yellow-Green 145D.

OTHER CHARACTERISTICS

Disease and pest resistance: Not observed to be susceptible  
nor resistant to normal diseases and pests of *Illicium floridanum*.  
Temperature tolerance: USDA Zone 6.  
Fruit/seed production: Star-like woody aggregate.  
What is claimed is:  
**1.** A new and distinct cultivar of *Illicium* plant named ‘JCJC’ as herein illustrated and described.

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Fig. 1



Fig. 2